

SMM Iron Ore Daily

2026-10-08 Thursday · Imported & Domestic Ore · Prices · Supply-Demand · Inventory · Commentary

Source SMM / SGX

Futures Contracts

SGX: latest price · DCE: close

SGX Iron Ore Current-month Contract

Latest price

91.10 USD/dmt

FEFV26 · 2026-10 · SGX · delayed

As of preparation: 2026-10-08 18:08:57 (UTC+8)

Quote time: 10-08 17:47:03 (UTC+8)

DCE Iron Ore Most-traded I2701

Daily

682.5 yuan/mt

▼ -20.0 -2.85%

MTD avg 682.5

As of Oct 8 · vs Sep 30

SMM Iron Ore Price Index

Indices as of Oct 8

MMi 61% Port Spot

Daily

664 yuan/wmt

▼ -10 -1.48%

MTD avg 664

MMi 58% Port Spot

Daily

627 yuan/wmt

▼ -11 -1.72%

MTD avg 627

MMi 65% Port Spot

Daily

828 yuan/wmt

▼ -10 -1.19%

MTD avg 828

MMi 61% Seaborne Index

Daily

90.35 USD/dmt

▼ -0.90 -0.99%

MTD avg 91.77

MMi 65% Seaborne Index

Daily

109.45 USD/dmt

▼ -0.25 -0.23%

MTD avg 110.48

SMM Domestic Ore Composite Index

Daily

831.59 yuan/mt

▼ -5.86 -0.70%

MTD avg —

index as of Sep 24 · vs Sep 23

Key View

Prices fall on reopening; the key is whether coke cost relief translates into stronger buying

Price adjustments on reopening suggest that the soft expectations built during the holiday are feeding into domestic trading. DCE most-traded closed at 682.5 yuan/mt, down 2.85% from before the break; most mainstream Qingdao fines fell 15 yuan/wmt and PB Lump fell 17 yuan. The seaborne 61% index eased to USD 90.35/dmt and the 65% to 109.45, while all 12 brand quotations declined. Although mill enquiries resumed, SMM reported continued pressure on bids and only moderate trading, suggesting that lower prices have yet to attract significantly stronger demand.

Costs offer a cushion. SMM's Oct 8 briefing confirmed the first round of coke purchase-price cuts effective Oct 1, at 100 yuan/mt for wet-quenched and 110 yuan/mt for dry-quenched coke; the latest freight readings also declined. These changes may improve cost conditions for mills or traders, but actual margin repair depends on relative movements in finished-steel prices, ore prices and exchange rates. If mills continue to control arrivals and buy only to immediate needs, the demand response to cost relief may take time.

The near-term question is whether trading and production respond to the price adjustment. Global shipments remain relatively high, while hot metal and maintenance conditions constrain demand expectations. Tight domestic concentrate resources offer support, but mill pressure on bids persists. Prices may remain soft and range-bound. Sustained restocking following margin improvement could provide a floor; if trading recovery is limited, pressure from incoming supply may continue to dominate.

Today's Highlights

◆ **Futures and port spot prices fell on the first session after the holiday.** DCE most-traded I2701 closed at **682.5 yuan/mt**, down 20.0 yuan (-2.85%) from the last pre-holiday close. Qingdao PB Fines were 650 yuan/wmt, Newman Fines 653 and Mac Fines 652, each down 15 yuan; PB Lump fell 17 yuan to 843 yuan/wmt.

◆ **Seaborne indices and brand quotations continued lower.** On Oct 8, the MMi 61% seaborne index was **USD 90.35/dmt**, down 0.90 (-0.99%) from Oct 7; the 65% was **109.45**, down 0.25 (-0.23%). All 12 brand quotations declined, with PB Fines at 90.60, Newman Fines 89.70 and Mac Fines 90.10 USD/dmt.

◆ **Port indices declined, with a slightly larger fall at the low-grade end.** The 61%, 58% and 65% port spot indices were 664, 627 and 828 yuan/wmt, down 10, 11 and 10 yuan from before the holiday. The 65%-58% spread widened marginally from 200 to 201 yuan/wmt.

◆ **Coke cost relief coexists with pressure on demand.** SMM's Oct 8 coking coal and coke briefing reported that major mills had confirmed a first-round purchase-price cut of 100 yuan/mt for wet-quenched coke and 110 yuan/mt for dry-quenched coke, effective Oct 1. Mills nevertheless continued buying to immediate needs and controlling arrivals; the transmission of cost relief to ore demand depends on margins and production plans.

Qingdao Port Imported Ore Spot Prices

yuan/wmt · tax incl.

Product	10-08 (yuan/wmt)	Daily change / %	MTD avg	Last 12 months
PB Fines 60.8% Daily	650	▼ -15 -2.26%	650	
Newman Fines 61.2% Daily	653	▼ -15 -2.25%	653	
Mac Fines 60.8% Daily	652	▼ -15 -2.25%	652	
BRBF 62.5% Daily	705	▼ -15 -2.08%	705	
Newman Lump 63% Daily	845	▼ -15 -1.74%	845	
Super Special Fines (SSF) 56.5% Daily	512	▼ -15 -2.85%	512	
Carajas Fines (IOC.J) 65% Daily	827	▼ -15 -1.78%	827	
PB Lump 61.5% Daily	843	▼ -17 -1.98%	843	

Seaborne Brand Prices in USD & MMi Indices

USD/dmt

Seaborne Brand Prices in USD CFR Qingdao

Product	10-08 (USD/dmt)	Daily change / %	10-07
Roy Hill Fines 62% Daily	87.00	▼ -0.95 -1.08%	87.95
SIMEC Fines 61% Daily	88.70	▼ -0.95 -1.06%	89.65
PB Fines 62% Daily	90.60	▼ -0.90 -0.98%	91.50
Newman Fines 60.7% Daily	89.70	▼ -0.90 -0.99%	90.60
Mac Fines 60.5% Daily	90.10	▼ -0.90 -0.99%	91.00
Jimblebar Fines 60.30% Daily	86.05	▼ -0.90 -1.04%	86.95
Carajas Fines (IOC.J) 65% Daily	105.65	▼ -1.20 -1.12%	106.85
SSFT / SSFG 60% Daily	95.75	▼ -1.30 -1.34%	97.05
Brazilian Blend Fines (BRBF) 64% Daily	95.95	▼ -1.15 -1.18%	97.10
RTX Fines 61% Daily	85.30	▼ -0.90 -1.04%	86.20
West Pilbara Fines (WPF) 60% Daily	90.10	▼ -0.95 -1.04%	91.05
SP10 Fines 59%-60% Daily	78.45	▼ -0.90 -1.13%	79.35

SMM Iron Ore Price Index monthly statistics

Index	Month-to-date avg	MoM	YTD	Unit	Last 12 months
SMM MMi 61% Iron Ore Seaborne Index Daily	91.77	-4.91%	-14.7%	USD/dmt	
SMM MMi 65% Iron Ore Seaborne Index Daily	110.48	-3.46%	-9.8%	USD/dmt	
SMM MMi 61% Iron Ore Port Spot Index Daily	664	-4.07%	-18.3%	yuan/wmt	
SMM MMi 65% Iron Ore Port Spot Index Daily	828	-1.38%	-7.9%	yuan/wmt	
SMM MMi 58% Iron Ore Port Spot Index Daily	627	-3.15%	-12.7%	yuan/wmt	
SMM China Domestic Ore Composite Price Index Daily	—	—	-6.2%	yuan/mt	

On Oct 8, the seaborne 61% index was USD 90.35/dmt (-0.99%) and the 65% was 109.45 (-0.23%), widening their spread from USD 18.45 to 19.10/dmt. The 61%, 58% and 65% port indices were 664, 627 and 828 yuan/wmt, down 10, 11 and 10 yuan from before the holiday.

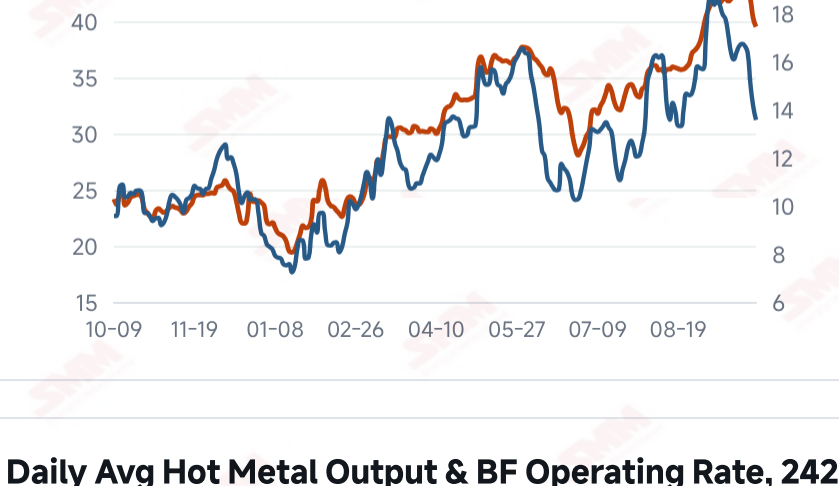
* SMM yuan quotations for Newman Fines and PB Lump start in Mar 2026; their sparklines cover that shorter window only. All others show the past year.

Key Price Drivers

Last 12 months

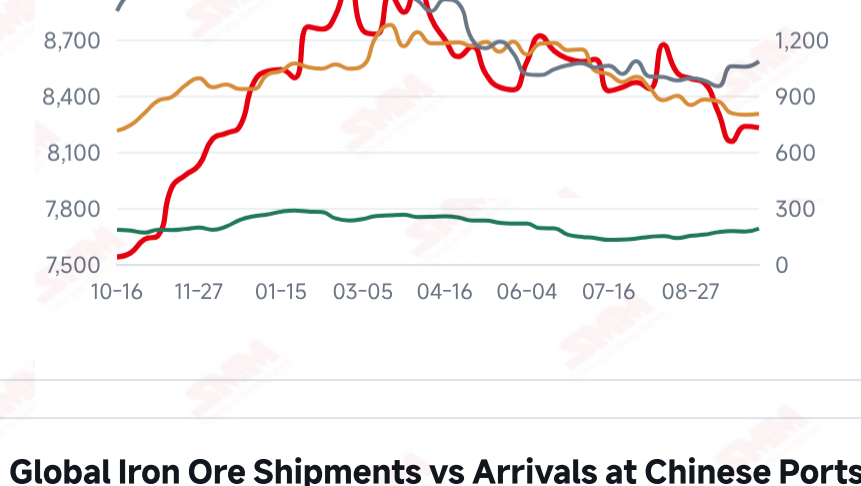
Iron Ore Ocean Freight

USD/mt · daily · last 12M · C3 Tubarao→Beilun/Baoshan, C5 W. Australia Dampier→Qingdao/Beilun/Baoshan



Iron Ore Port Inventory at 10 Ports · by Product

Left: fines Right: concentrates / lump / pellets · 10,000 mt · weekly



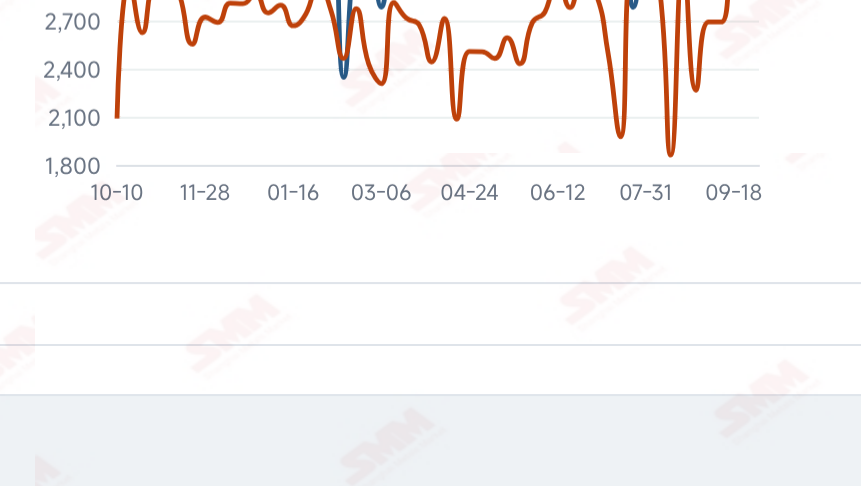
Daily Avg Hot Metal Output & BF Operating Rate, 242 Mills

Left: 10,000 mt Right: % · weekly



Global Iron Ore Shipments vs Arrivals at Chinese Ports

10,000 mt · weekly · shipments 123 ports / arrivals 61 ports



Market Commentary · Imported Ore

Futures & spot DCE most-traded I2701 closed at 682.5 yuan/mt, down 2.85% from 702.5 on Sep 30. Qingdao PB Fines were 650, Newman Fines 653, Mac Fines 652, BRBF 705, Newman Lump 845, SSF 512 and Carajas Fines 827 yuan/wmt, each down 15 yuan from before the holiday; PB Lump fell 17 yuan to 843. SMM's daily review described active mill enquiries but strong pressure on bids and only moderate overall trading. SGX official delayed data showed current-month FEFV26 at USD 91.10/dmt, timestamped Oct 8, 17:47:03 (UTC+8).

Drivers Weaker domestic futures and spot prices on reopening may reflect the transmission of offshore adjustments during the holiday. Index-fueled mill enquiries did not immediately translate into stronger transaction support. The seaborne 61% index fell more than the 65%, with the seaborne grade spread from USD 18.45 to 19.10/dmt, but a one-day change is insufficient to establish a structural shift in blending demand. Price stabilisation will depend more on the strength of mill buying and sustained port trading.

Demand SMM's Sep 30 survey of 242 mills showed daily hot metal output of 2.3882 million mt, down 6,100 mt WoW; the blast furnace operating rate was 88.57% and capacity utilisation 88.15%. The Oct 8 coking coal and coke briefing described cautious buying, controlled arrivals and maintenance scheduled at some mills. The earlier estimate of 1.6839 million mt of blast furnace maintenance losses for Oct 3-9 remains a weekly projection. If margin improvement is limited, raw-material purchases may continue to focus on immediate needs.

Inventory & supply In the week to Oct 2, global shipments reached 35.9424 million mt, up 430,300 mt WoW. Brazil shipped 8.5967 million mt, up 1.8195 million, while Australia shipped 19.4645 million mt, down 1.2988 million. Arrivals in China fell 368,200 mt to 29.0943 million mt. The latest port stock readings were 103.0165 million mt across 10 ports on Sep 30 and 145.45 million mt across 35 ports on Sep 25. High shipment levels may influence subsequent arrivals, with routes and unloading schedules shaping the actual pressure.

Cost & margin SMM's Oct 8 briefing reported the first round of coke price cuts effective Oct 1: 100 yuan/mt for wet-quenched and 110 yuan/mt for dry-quenched coke. This offers mill cost relief but does not imply an immediate increase in raw-material buying. The latest freight readings, dated Sep 30, were USD 39.51/mt for C3 and 13.56/mt for C5, down 1.86% and 4.03% from the previous observation. Import trading margins still depend on relative changes in port selling prices, seaborne procurement costs, exchange rates and freight.

Market Commentary · Domestic Ore

Prices SMM's Oct 8 domestic ore brief reported modest concentrate price declines during the holiday against pre-holiday levels: 20-25 yuan/mt in Shandong and Anhui, 5-10 yuan/mt in Hebei, with northeastern China relatively stable. The latest Domestic Ore Composite Price Index reading was 831.59 yuan/mt on Sep 24.

Supply & demand Domestic resources remained relatively tight, offering some price support, but mill losses and pressure on bids were strong. Supply constraints may not fully offset demand weakness. National concentrate output was 18.87 million mt in September, with inventory at 280,000 mt; regional conditions and long-term contract execution continue to influence available supply.

Outlook SMM expects domestic concentrate prices may edge lower in the short term. If hot metal output and mill buying intensity do not recover, weaker imported ore prices may add pressure. Whether lower coke costs improve profitability enough to stimulate purchases will be an important indicator.

Market Factors

Supportive factors

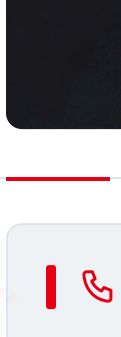
- The first round of coke purchase-price cuts offers mill cost relief.
- Mill enquiries resumed after the holiday, creating scope for better trading.
- Domestic concentrates remain relatively tight, supporting some regional markets.
- Arrivals in China fell 1.25% WoW in the week to Oct 2.

Bearish factors

- DCE fell 2.85% from the pre-holiday close, while port spot quotations broadly declined.
- The seaborne 61% index fell 0.99% and all 12 brand quotations declined.
- Mills continued to press bids lower, with no clear strengthening in overall trading.
- High shipment levels and maintenance schedules may continue to shape the supply-demand balance.

Flash News

- [Domestic Iron Ore Brief] Domestic concentrates prices may continue to decline in the short term 2026-10-08
- [SMM Coking Coal and Coke Daily Briefing] 20261008 2026-10-08
- [SMM Steel] European HRC Prices Diverge as North-South Price Gap Narrows 2026-10-08
- [SMM Steel] Indonesian HRC Climbs \$5/mt to \$525 FOB as Mills Feel Stronger Demand 2026-10-08
- [SMM Steel] Indian HRC Prices Hold Steady; European Access and Import Competition Remain in Focus 2026-10-08
- [SMM Steel] Iranian Billet Export Prices Rise Amid Tight Supply and Energy Shortages 2026-10-08



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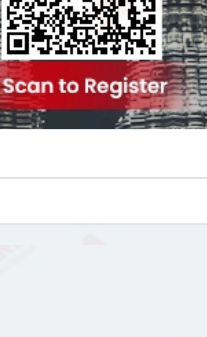
400+ Delegates

20+ Exhibitors

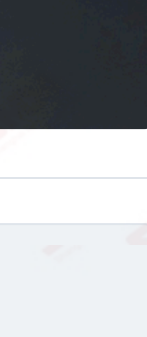
50+ Speakers

30+ Countries & Regions

10+ Distinct Topics



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